

Phishing Awareness Training

What are phishing Attacks: Phishing emails messages, websites, text and phone calls are design to steal money or sensitive information. Cybercriminals can do this by install malicious software on your computer by tricking you into giving them sensitive information, or outright stealing personal information off your computer.

Example of phishing

Social Engineering: A staff list on the main company site or many of your social media profiles can include information such as Name, Date of birth, location, work place, hobbies, your relationship status, email address, telephone number and favorite food. This and every potential information off the dark web is everything a cybercriminal needs to fool you into thinking that the message or email is legitimate.

Link manipulation: most phishing method use some form of deception designed to make a link in an email appear to belong to an organization or person. Misdirected or misspelled URLs are common. Many email programs will show the actual link if you hover the mouse cursor over a link.

Spear phishing: Directed at an individual or a company. They have done their social engineering research and have enough personal information to make the email appear from a trusted source. Currently the most successful sources tactic at 91%.

Clone Phishing: A phishing attack whereby a legitimate and previously delivered email containing an attachment or link has had its content and recipient address taken and used to create an almost identical or cloned email. The attachment or link within the email is replaced with a malicious version and then sent from an email address spoofed to appear to come from the original senders

Voice phishing: commonly called **vishing**, is a type of phishing attack carried out through phone calls or voice communication.

The attacker pretends to be someone you trust—such as a bank employee, government official, company representative, technical-support agent, or even someone you know—to trick you into giving them sensitive information or sending money.

Example

Imagine you receive a call:

Hello, I'm calling from your bank. We detected suspicious activity on your account. To secure your account, please tell me the OTP that was just sent to your phone.

The caller may sound professional and convincing. But if you give them the OTP, they could use it to access your account.

Common vishing tricks

- **Fake bank calls:** We detected suspicious activity.
- **Fake customer support:** Your account has a technical problem.
- **Fake government calls:** You have an outstanding payment.
- **Fake job offers:** Pay a registration fee to receive your employment documents.
- **Family/emergency scams:** I'm in trouble and need money immediately.
- **Account verification scams:** Give me the code we just sent you.

How to protect yourself

Never give your password, PIN, or OTP to someone who calls you unexpectedly.

If someone claims to be from your bank or another organization:

1. End the call.
2. Find the organization's official contact number yourself.
3. Call them directly.
4. Verify whether the request was genuine.
5. Report the suspicious call if appropriate.

Tips to Protect Yourself from Phishing

1. **Think before you click**

Don't click links or open attachments in unexpected emails, SMS messages, or social-media messages.

2. **Check the sender**

Carefully examine the sender's email address or phone number. Attackers often use addresses that look similar to legitimate ones.

3. **Be careful with urgent messages**

Messages saying *"Act now," "Your account will be closed,"* or *"You must pay immediately"* are common phishing tactics.

4. **Never share passwords or OTPs**

Legitimate organizations generally won't ask you to reveal your password, PIN, or one-time verification code.

5. **Verify unusual requests**

If someone asks you to transfer money, provide sensitive information, or change account details, contact the person or organization through a trusted channel.

6. **Check website addresses**

Before entering your login details, make sure you're on the correct website. Don't rely only on how professional the website looks.

7. **Don't trust unexpected attachments**

If you weren't expecting a file, verify it with the sender before opening it.

8. **Use strong, unique passwords**

Don't use the same password across multiple accounts. A compromised password can otherwise affect several accounts.

9. **Enable multi-factor authentication (MFA)**

MFA provides an additional layer of protection if your password is stolen.

10. **Keep your software updated**

Update your operating system, browser, antivirus/security software, and applications to reduce security vulnerabilities.

11. **Be careful with phone calls (vishing)**

Never give sensitive information to someone simply because they claim to be from your bank, company, or another trusted organization.

12. Report suspicious messages

If you receive a suspected phishing message, report it to your organization's IT/security team or the relevant service provider.